

Xiang Pan

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Research Interests

My research lies at the intersection of human–robot interaction, social robotics, and embodied AI. My doctoral research focused on developing expressive manipulation strategies to improve the transparency, legibility, and naturalness of robot behavior in human-shared environments. My postdoctoral research investigates how robots can infer and respond to human intentions by leveraging large language models (LLMs) and vision-language models (VLMs), while drawing on insights from psychology to enable socially appropriate behavior in human–robot interaction.

Employment

02/2026 – Present **Kyoto University** – Kyoto, Japan
Postdoctoral Researcher
Supervisor: [Prof. Takayuki Kanda](#)

Education

04/2022 – 01/2026 **Kyoto University** – Kyoto, Japan
Ph.D. in Social Informatics
Supervisor: [Prof. Takayuki Kanda](#)

10/2020 – 08/2021 **Northeast Normal University** – Changchun, China
Japanese Language Studies

09/2017 – 06/2020 **Zhejiang University** – Hangzhou, China
M.S. in Instrument and Meter Engineering
Supervisor: [Prof. Hong Zhou](#)

09/2013 – 07/2017 **Anhui University of Technology** – Ma’anshan, China
B.S. in Electronic and Information Engineering
Supervisor: [Prof. Bing Wang](#)

Full Papers in Conference Proceedings

2026 **Communicating Object Relations through Robot Gestures.**
Xiang Pan*, Malcolm Doering, Takayuki Kanda. In Proceedings of the 2026 ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction.
CORE A*; acceptance rate: 23.2% (129/557).

2025 **Communicating Physical Properties through Robot Object Manipulation.**
Xiang Pan*, Malcolm Doering, Stela H. Seo, Takayuki Kanda. In Proceedings of the 2025 ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction.
CORE A*; acceptance rate: 25% (100/400).

2024 **What Is Your Other Hand Doing, Robot? A Model of Behavior for Shopkeeper Robot’s Idle Hand.**
Xiang Pan*, Malcolm Doering, Takayuki Kanda. In Proceedings of the 2024 ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction.
CORE A*; acceptance rate: 24.7% (87/352).

2019 **Efficient Barcode Localization Method for Low-Quality Images.**
Xiang Pan, Dong Li, Weijia Wu, Hong Zhou. In Proceedings of the 2019 International Conference on Graphics and Signal Processing.

Invention Patents

2024	High Voltage LED Chip Set, LED Light Source for Plant Light Supplementation and Illuminating Device. Xiang Pan, Xuke Li. US Patent US12051677B2, granted.
2023	LED Light Source for Plant Light Supplementation and Lamp Comprising the Same. Xuke Li, Xiang Pan. European Patent EP3767167B1, granted.
2022	LED Light Source for Supplemental Lighting for Plants and Lamp with Light Source. Xuke Li, Xiang Pan. US Patent US11419278B2, granted.

Teaching Experience

2025	Information System Analysis Teaching Assistant
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Academic Service

Organizing

HRI '26	Workshop Organizer Multi-Agentic Systems in HRI (MAgicS-HRI): Bridging Design and Real-World Challenges for End Users
ICIRA '26	Special Session Organizer MUSE: Multimodal Human Motion Understanding for Embodied and Interactive Intelligence

Reviewing

	THRI Distinguished Reviewer Board
Journals	RA-L; THRI; IMWUT
Conferences	HRI (2025–27); CHI (2023); DIS (2025–26); IDC (2025–26); ISS (2026); INTERACT (2025); WHC (2025); AutoUI (2026); RO-MAN (2024); HAI (2024, 2026)

Invited Talks

2025	Communicating Object Relations through Robot Gestures. Invited Speaker, Center for Digital Media Computation, Xiamen University
2024	Communicating Physical Properties through Robot Object Manipulation. Invited Speaker, Center for Digital Media Computation, Xiamen University

Selected Awards

2021	Japanese Government (MEXT) Scholarship Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology
2020	Excellent Postgraduate Student Award Zhejiang University
2018	Outstanding Graduate Student Leader Award Zhejiang University

- 2017 **Outstanding Graduate Award**
Anhui Province
- 2017 **Youth May Fourth Medal**
Anhui University of Technology (highest undergraduate honor; 10 recipients
university-wide)